

## 20 HOBBIES, LEISURE AND LIFESTYLE



*Leisure time is that five or six hours when you sleep at night.*

*George Allen*

*If you have no problems at your job, you don't have a job, you've got a hobby.*

*Ronald Dunn*

### □ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- free time, spare time, pastime, leisure, likes, dislikes
- **reasons for practising hobbies:** to have fun, to entertain others, to be in the company of other people, make new friendships, to develop talent, to go out, to stay fit, to prevent children from taking drugs or drinking alcohol, to have some interest, to complement our work or study, to relax, to care for pets, to enjoy something, to find a balance in life
- **types of hobbies:** individual, practised in groups, creative, life-long, old fashioned, exclusive, time-consuming, expensive, traditional, unusual/strange/extraordinary
- **examples of hobbies:**
  - *collecting:* stamps, picture postcards, napkins, badges, flags, coins, model cars, stickers
  - *handicrafts:* knitting, sewing, embroidering
  - *doing sports:* jogging, roller skating, inline skating, skateboarding, scuba diving, playing golf, playing badminton, hiking, cycling, rowing, bodybuilding, yachting, hot air ballooning, Zumba dancing
  - *playing games:* chess, dice games, board games, memory games, card games, word games
  - *playing musical instruments:* the piano, the violin, the guitar, the drums, the cello, the flute
  - *art activities:* choir singing, painting, drawing, pottery, reading/writing poems, going to art galleries, listening to music, composing music, acting, photography, crafts
  - *hobbies around the house:* gardening, house maintenance, DIY, car repair, cookery, baking
  - *caring for pets/keeping pets:* horse riding, walking dogs, feeding your tortoise, cleaning an aquarium/cage/stable, fishing
  - *unusual hobbies:* plane/train/car spotting, caving, pottery
- **extracurricular activities:** school clubs, leisure centres, applicants, course instructors
- **lifestyle:** of the young, the adult, the retired/pensioners

### □ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Why do people practise hobbies?
2. Which hobbies are very common among your friends?
3. Which hobbies did you have as a child?

4. Why are hobbies connected to lifestyle?
5. How can people spend their leisure time at home?
6. What do you think of keeping pets as a hobby?
7. Do you keep a pet? If so, how do you look after it?
8. Which hobbies do people practise to develop their talent for arts?
9. Which hobbies can be dangerous? Why?
10. Are there enough opportunities/facilities/clubs where you can practise your hobbies? Give examples.

## □ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

### LEISURE TIME

Free time after work or study is called **leisure time**. It is the time for fun and **entertainment**. Some people like **to be on their own** and learn new things by reading books or **participating in cultural events**. Others enjoy **company** and often go out or play team sports. It is important to choose hobbies that **fit** our character and **complement** our work or study well. We do them because we need to relax and want to have a good time. However, there are more and more workaholics in our country who **gave up** their hobbies in order to be able to work all the time. Psychologists **consider** this to be a very negative **phenomenon**.

1. What is leisure time?
2. What are common ways of spending free time?

### TRADITIONAL VS. CREATIVE HOBBIES

One of the traditional hobbies is the collecting of objects – **stamps**, picture postcards, **napkins**, **badges**, **flags**, **coins**, **stickers**, model cars or ships and other things. Collecting can become a **lifelong** hobby for many people. Collectors meet to exchange the things they collect. However, this hobby is gradually becoming **old-fashioned**. In the past, hobbies such as **knitting**, **embroidering** and **sewing** were very widespread among women in Slovakia. Nowadays, they are rarely seen. Some people have creative hobbies, such as acting, singing in a **choir**, folk dancing or playing pop-music in **amateur groups**. Photography, painting and drawing are also popular hobbies. There are many opportunities for people to **develop their talents** in these **areas**.

3. Which hobbies do you consider old-fashioned? What kind of people still practise them?
4. Which creative hobbies are mentioned in the text above?

## HOBBIES FOR DIFFERENT AGES

People of all ages enjoy spending their leisure time practising their hobbies. Many children and young people join different clubs. The most popular are football, tennis, dance or **horse riding** clubs. Some parents **force** their children **to play an instrument** or do some sport because they think that they will **prevent** them **from** taking drugs or drinking alcohol by doing this. Others **failed** to become musicians or sportsmen themselves, so they want their children to **achieve** these **aims**. Teenagers have their own special leisure interests which **form part of** their youth culture. These **include** playing team sports, dancing or going to parties. They like to spend their leisure time actively **in their friends' company**. Those who prefer staying at home usually watch DVDs, listen to music or **browse the Internet**. Typical teenage sports are **roller skating** and skateboarding. In Slovakia, new **cycle** and inline skating **paths** have been built for skateboarders, roller skaters and cyclists. Older people prefer gardening, fishing, reading, going to the theatre, concerts or **art exhibitions**. Slovak **pensioners** are quite traditional and prefer staying at home and do not travel as much as many American **retired** people. A lot of people, both children and adults, **keep a pet** – a dog, a cat, a goldfish, a **canary**, a **parrot**, a **guinea pig** or other more exotic animals. To **care for** a pet well **requires** a good knowledge of their habits and behaviour.

5. What are typical teenage hobbies?
6. Why do parents want their children to have hobbies such as playing a musical instrument or playing a sport?

## SPORTS AS HOBBIES

More and more people of all ages are **concerned with** their health and spend some of their leisure time doing exercises to keep fit. **Hiking**, cycling, **rowing**, playing golf and tennis are **outdoor** activities enjoyed by people everywhere. For those who prefer physical exercises **indoors**, bodybuilding and fitness centres are opening up all over the world. They help people stay healthy and fit. This can also be achieved by walking, jogging or swimming, which are also effective and very popular ways of spending leisure time. Finally, there is a group of **exclusive sports** which are practised as hobbies by a limited number of people. **Hot air ballooning** is a fascinating **though** very expensive hobby. It may also be a dangerous hobby when the weather is unpredictable and the wind is too strong. Other increasingly popular hobbies are **skydiving**, **hang gliding** and wind-surfing. A relatively **recent** sport which has already **attracted the attention of a number of** young people is snowboarding which combines skiing, surfing and skateboarding. Many snowboarders practise this sport in the Slovak or Austrian mountains. Some Slovaks like expensive sports that are not so common in our country and they often travel abroad to practise them. These include playing golf, yachting and **scuba diving**.

7. Why do people play sports as a hobby?
8. Which exclusive sports are mentioned in the text above?

## BRITISH AND SLOVAK HOBBIES

The British love animals and many families have a pet; usually a cat or a dog which becomes part of the family. Many British people also love gardening. They prefer living in small houses **rather than** flats. The saying "*My house is my castle*" is true for many British people. Do-It-Yourself or just **DIY** (doing practical jobs around the house) has become a very popular hobby. Slovaks like to redecorate their houses or to **repair** pieces of furniture and **household appliances**. There are people who like to repair their cars by themselves, others do **cooking** etc. We can say that Slovaks also like gardening and they do jobs around the house themselves. However, we do not have as many evening classes that are organised for those who want to learn the **basics** of these activities as they have in Britain.

9. Explain the English saying "My house is my castle" in relation to housing as a hobby.
10. Why is DIY considered to be a hobby rather than a necessity?

## □ VOCABULARY LIST

**amateur group** – amatérska skupina  
**area** [eəriə] – oblasť  
**art exhibition** – výstava výtvarného umenia  
**badge** [bædʒ] – odznak  
**basics** – základy  
**canary** – kanárik  
**to care for** – starať sa o  
**choir** [kwaɪə(r)] – zbor (spevácky)  
**coin** – minca  
**company** – spoločnosť (ľudí, priateľov)  
**to complement** – dopĺňať  
**to concern with** [kən'sɜ:n] – zaujímať sa o  
**to consider** – považovať za  
**cooking** – varenie  
**cultural event** [ɪ'vent] – kultúrna udalosť  
**cycle path** [saɪkl pa:θ] – cyklistický chodník  
**embroidering** – vyšívanie  
**exclusive sport** – exkluzívny šport  
**to fail** – zlyhať, neuspieť  
**to fit** – hodiť sa  
**flag** – zástava  
**to force** – prinútiť  
**to give up** – vzdať sa  
**guinea pig** – morča  
**hang gliding** [hæŋɡlaɪdɪŋ] – lietanie na rogate  
**hiking** [haɪkɪŋ] – pešia turistika  
**horse riding** – jazda na koni  
**hot air ballooning** – lietanie na  
 teplovzdušnom balóne

**household appliance** [haʊshəʊld ə'plaɪəns] –  
 domáci spotrebič  
**to include** – zahrňovať  
**indoors** – vo vnútri  
**knitting** [nɪtɪŋ] – pletenie  
**leisure time** [leɪʒə(r)] – voľný čas  
**life-long** – celoživotný  
**napkin** – servítko  
**old-fashioned** – staromódny  
**outdoor** – vonku, v prírode  
**parrot** – papagáj  
**to participate in** – zúčastniť sa na  
**pensioner** – dôchodca, dôchodkyňa  
**phenomenon** [fə'nɒmɪnən] (pl. phenomena)  
 – jav  
**to prevent from** – zabrániť  
**rather than** – radšej ako  
**recent** [ri:snt] – nedávny  
**to require** [rɪkwaɪə] – vyžadovať  
**retired** – v dôchodku  
**roller skating** – korčuľovanie  
**rowing** – veslovanie  
**scuba diving** [sku:bə daɪvɪŋ] – potápanie  
 s kyslíkovou bombou  
**sewing** [səʊɪŋ] – šitie  
**skydiving** [skaɪdaɪvɪŋ] – parašutizmus  
**stamp** – poštová známka  
**sticker** – nálepka  
**though** [ðəʊ] – hoci, i keď

**a number of** – mnoho

**to achieve an aim** – dosiahnuť cieľ

**to attract the attention** – upriamiť pozornosť

**to be on one's own** – byť sám

**to browse the Internet** – prehliadať Internet

**to develop one's talent** – rozvíjať niekoho talent

**DIY (do it yourself)** – urob si sám

**to keep a pet** – chovať domáce zvieratko

**to play an instrument** – hrať na hudobný nástroj

## □ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

**Task 1** Which of the following hobbies are individual hobbies and hobbies practised in groups (or both)? Which of them do you consider to be unusual? Why?

*pottery – skateboarding – horse riding – knitting – collecting coins – playing the drums – choir singing – aerobics – bodybuilding – train spotting – cookery – painting – caving – hiking – yachting – diving – photography – DIY – car tuning*

**Task 2** Choose three hobbies from Task 1 and using a dictionary, make a list of all the instruments/equipment/tools/special clothes you need to do them.

*Example: painting: canvas, paintbrush, paint colours...*

**Task 3** Which hobbies would you recommend to these people? Which hobbies wouldn't you recommend to them? Explain why.

1. a bored teenager who likes movement, fun and the company of friends
2. a talented girl who likes singing
3. an older man who works a lot physically
4. a middle-aged woman who wants to lose some weight
5. a pregnant woman who can't play any sports
6. a teenage girl who loves extreme sports
7. a retired couple who like spending time together
8. a hyperactive small child
9. a middle-aged man after having a knee operation
10. an only child who feels lonely and is bored